

# Year 5 Reading Comprehension - Bushfire Preparedness

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

ACARA v9.0: AC9E5LY05 - use comprehension strategies to analyse information, ideas and literal and inferred meaning in texts.

## Learning Intention

I can read an informational text and explain how details support the main idea.

## Reading Strategy

Look for cause and effect words, safety actions and evidence that explains why people prepare early.

## Vocabulary Helper

**preparedness:** planning before a possible danger

**evacuation:** leaving a place to stay safe

**ember:** a small glowing piece from a fire

**community:** people who live, learn or work together

## Before You Read

Think of one way families or schools prepare for very hot weather or emergencies.

## Bushfire Preparedness in a Small Community

In the town of Wattle Creek, summer preparation begins long before the first hot day. Families check gutters, clear dry leaves and talk about where they will go if a bushfire warning is issued. The local fire brigade visits the school each November to explain why small jobs can become important safety actions.

One lesson surprises many students: bushfires do not only move as flames. Strong winds can carry embers ahead of the fire front. An ember can land in dry leaves, on a wooden deck or near a garden shed. That is why residents are asked to remove loose rubbish and keep outdoor areas tidy.

At school, Year 5 students create a map showing safe meeting points, main roads and places where people can find updates. They also practise reading warning levels so they understand the difference between advice, watch and act, and emergency warnings.

By the end of the visit, the class understands that preparation is not panic. It is a calm way for neighbours, families and schools to look after one another before danger arrives.

# Year 5 Reading Comprehension - Bushfire Preparedness

Questions and written response

## Warm Up

Circle the best text type: narrative / informational text / poem. Then write one sentence explaining your choice.

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## Build Your Skills

1. What does Wattle Creek begin doing before the first hot day?

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2. Why can embers be dangerous during a bushfire?

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3. How do the Year 5 students help the community prepare?

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4. What is the main message of the final paragraph?

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5. Find one detail that shows preparation is a shared community responsibility.

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6. Why might the author say preparation is not panic?

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## Strong Challenge

Write a short safety announcement for families in Wattle Creek. Use two facts from the text.

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## I Can

- ☐ I read carefully.
- ☐ I used evidence.
- ☐ I explained my thinking.

## High Five!

**Strong reading! You used evidence carefully and explained your thinking.**

## Teacher Feedback

Strength: \_\_\_\_\_

Next: \_\_\_\_\_

# Bushfire Preparedness - Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

## Detailed Answers

1. They check gutters, clear dry leaves, discuss evacuation plans and learn from the fire brigade.
2. Embers can travel ahead of flames and start new fires when they land on dry or flammable material.
3. They create a map of safe meeting points, roads and update places, and practise reading warning levels.
4. Preparation helps people make calm decisions and support each other.
5. Accept answers about families, the fire brigade, school students or neighbours working together.
6. It means preparation is sensible planning, not fear. It helps people act calmly.

## Success Guide

Strong responses refer back to the text, explain why preparation matters and use words such as because, therefore or this shows.

## Parent Tip - At Home

Ask your child to choose one safety detail from the passage and explain it in their own words. Keep it practical: What would we check at home before a hot day?

## Teacher Tip - In Class

Model one evidence sentence on the board: The text says \_\_\_\_\_. This shows \_\_\_\_\_. Then students answer independently using the same frame.

## Extension Idea

Create a two-column chart: Preparation action / Why it helps.